

PRIMARY SCHOOL

CONCEPTUAL CLASSIFICATION-BASED QUESTIONS

- Each interview with a student will last approximately 25 minutes.
- The following questions will be asked selectively by the interviewer depending on the course and progression of the research and the interview.
- If a question cannot be answered or is not understood, or if the answer is not sufficiently long, does not meet expectations, etc., prompting questions may be used. These questions do not have to be asked.

I. Family Relationships

1. Who are the members of a family?
2. Can you tell me about your family? Please tell me everything that comes to mind.
3. What does a family do together on weekdays (days when children go to school)? How do they spend time together?
4. What does a family do together on weekends (days when children do not go to school)? How do they spend time together?
5. What does a family do together during holidays?
6. What do we call people who are born to the same mother and father?

If you have siblings, what do you do together?

Is having a sibling a good thing? If yes or no, why?

7. a. What are your mother's and father's parents to you?

(If the student has already used words such as "grandfather," "grandmother," etc. in Question 1, Question 7a will not be asked; proceed to Questions 7b and 7c.)

7.b. When do you usually get together with your maternal grandfather and grandmother, and what do you do together?

7.c. When do you usually get together with your paternal grandfather and grandmother, and what do you do together?

8. a. What is your mother's sister, brother, or sibling to you?

(If the student has already used words such as "aunt" or "uncle" in Question 1, Question 8a will not be asked; proceed to Questions 8b, 8c, and 8d.)

8.b. If your aunt or uncle is married, what is their spouse (wife or husband) to you?

8.c. What are your aunt's or uncle's children to you?

8.d. When do you usually get together with your aunt, uncle, their spouses, or your cousins, and what do you do together?

9. a. What is your father's sister, brother, or sibling to you?

(If the student has already used words such as "aunt" or "uncle" in Question 1, Question 9a will not be asked; proceed to Questions 9b, 9c, and 9d.)

9.b. If your aunt or uncle is married, what is their spouse (wife or husband) to you?

9.c. What are your aunt's or uncle's children to you?

9.d. When do you usually get together with your aunt, uncle, their spouses, or your cousins, and what do you do together?

II. Morality and Ethics

1. What makes someone a good person? What kind of person are they, what do they do, and how do they behave?
2. What makes someone a bad person? What kind of person are they, what do they do, and how do they behave?
3. Is lying good or bad? Why? → So, not lying is good behavior. What other behaviors are good, like not lying? Why? → So, lying is a bad behavior. What other behaviors are bad, like lying? Why?
4. Is it normal to treat someone badly? If yes or no, why?
5. Imagine that your teacher gives every student in the class a piece of chocolate but does not give one to a particular student. Is this the right thing to do?
 - Why is it or isn't it right?
 - What would you do if this happened?
 - How would you feel if this happened?
6. Imagine that Ayşe and Mehmet are friends and are in the same class. Ayşe borrowed a pencil from Mehmet one month ago. After some time, Mehmet said to Ayşe, “If you don't need my pencil, could you give it back to me? My aunt bought that pencil for me, so it is very valuable and special to me.” But Ayşe said, “No, I won't give it back. It is my pencil now.”
 - What kind of behavior is Ayşe (the one that does not give the pencil back) showing?
 - How would Mehmet (the one that cannot get his pencil back) feel?
 - What would you do if a friend did this to you?

- How would you feel if a friend did this to you?

7. Imagine that you found a very nice pencil on the classroom floor, but you did not know who it belonged to. What would you do?

8. Imagine that Ayşe and Mehmet are friends and are in the same class. Mehmet's shoes are a little old. Ayşe sees this and says, "Mehmet, everyone in this class has brand-new shoes, but your shoes are very old."

- What kind of behavior is Ayşe (the one that said, "Your shoes are very old," to Mehmet) showing?
- What kind of person do you think Ayşe is?
- How would Mehmet feel in this situation?
- What would you do and how would you feel if a friend did this to you?

9. The students are waiting in line at the school cafeteria during recess. Because the line is long, Mehmet does not want to wait. He pushes Ayşe, who is second in line, and says, "This is my place. Move! Go to the back of the line."

- What kind of behavior is Mehmet (the one that pushed Ayşe and took her place) showing?
- What would you do and how would you feel if a friend did this to you?

III. Tools

1. Imagine that you need to cut a thick piece of cardboard and join the pieces together for a project. What would you need?
2. Imagine that you need to build a model house out of sticks for a project. What would you need?
3. Imagine that you want to hang a picture on the wall. What would you need?

4. Imagine that the door of your wardrobe is loose and might fall if it is not repaired. What would you need to repair the door?
5. What might be in a repairperson's tool bag when they go to work? What tools might they have?

IV. Shopping

1. Imagine that we are going shopping. What can we buy and where can we buy it?
(Prompting questions: Where can we buy food and drinks / clothes and shoes / detergent and chocolate / pencils and notebooks / sofas, coffee tables, and cabinets?)
2. Do you like shopping? If yes, what do you like buying when you go shopping? Where do you buy them? / If no, why don't you like it?
3. Is there anything you would like to buy for yourself these days? If so, what is it, where will you buy it, and why do you want to buy it?
4. When do people go shopping, and why do people shop?

V. Weights and Units of Measurements

1. Choose an object (for example, a table or a chair). How can we measure it, and how can we describe its measurement?
2. Choose an animal (for example, an elephant). How tall and how heavy do you think it is?
3. When we say “one and a half kilograms,” what does “half” mean?
4. When we say “one fifty” to describe someone's height, what does “one” mean and what does “fifty” mean?

VI. Holidays and Celebrations

1. When you hear the word “holiday,” which holidays come to mind? → What do people do on those holidays? → What do you do on those holidays? → How do you feel on those holidays?
2. Are there any holidays that you celebrate at school? → If so, which ones? → What did you do / what do you do on those holidays? → How did you feel / how do you feel on those holidays?
3. Which days come to mind when you hear “special days”? → What do people do on those special days? → What do you do on those special days? → How do you feel on those special days?
4. Can you think of a day that is celebrated for mothers, fathers, or children? → If so, which ones? → What do people do on those days? → What do you do on those days? → How do you feel on those days?

VII. Science

1. What objects or things are there in the sky?
2. Can you name some planets that you know? → What do you know about these planets? → What is the name of the planet we live on? → What is Earth like as a planet? For example, what shape is it? Does it rotate or stay still?
3. Why are there seasons? Why does the weather change instead of staying the same?
4. How is rain formed?
5. What is a plant before it grows? How does it grow, and what does it need to grow?
6. Are plants important for nature? If yes or no, why?
7. Are animals important for nature? If yes or no, why?
8. What do we call things that are liquids? What do we call things that are solids? What do we call things that are gases?
9. What comes to mind when you hear “our five senses”?

10. What is light? → What do we need light for? → What is a place with light like? → What is a place without light like? → What comes to mind when you hear “sources of light”?
11. What is sound → What kinds of sounds do different things make? → What comes to mind when you hear “sources of sound”?
12. What comes to mind when you hear “food”? → What comes to mind when you hear “types of food”?
13. What does “experiment” mean? → Why do we conduct experiments? → What kinds of things can we conduct experiments about?

VIII. Nature: Animals / Insects / Birds / Plants / Landforms

1. Imagine that your teacher asks you to draw a picture of nature. But they say, “Make it a detailed picture. Draw everything that comes to mind when you think of nature.” What would you draw in your picture of nature?
2. What kinds of animals come to mind when you hear “animal species”?
(Prompting question: For example, fish can live underwater but cats cannot. Cats can walk but snakes cannot. Could these animals be different species?)
3. Which animals come to mind when you hear “farm animals”? → Where do these animals live and what do they eat? → What do these animals look like?
4. Which birds come to mind when you hear “birds”? → Are there any species of birds that cannot fly? → What do birds look like? → Which of these birds live where, and what do they eat?
5. Which animals come to mind when you hear “animals that live in water”? → Where do these animals live, and how do they feed? → What do they look like?
6. Which animals come to mind when you hear “reptiles”? → Where do these animals live, and how do they feed? → What do they look like?

7. Which insects come to mind when you hear “insects”? → Where do these insects live, and how do they feed? → What do they look like?
8. Can you tell me about animals that live in forests? → What do these animals eat? → What do they look like?
9. What does “pet” mean? → Which animals come to mind when you hear “pet”? → What do these animals eat?
10. Which plants come to mind when you hear “plants”?
11. Which trees come to mind when you hear “tree”? → What grows on trees? → Are trees useful for our environment? → If yes, what are their benefits?
12. Are flowers plants? Can you name some flowers that you know? What do you know about these flowers?
13. What do we call things such as mountains and seas? → What other things like mountains and seas do you know? Can you name them?

IX. Emotions

1. How do you feel when someone gives you a present?
2. How do you feel when you are having a really good time with your friend at the park?
3. How do you feel when your teacher says “Well done!” to you?
4. How do you feel when someone surprises you?
5. How do you feel if you lose something that you really love?
6. How do you feel if you argue or have a fight with a friend you really like?

7. Imagine that your teacher asks everyone in the class to draw a picture of a forest. Everyone makes their pictures, but your teacher says that they really liked everyone's picture except yours.
How would you feel?
8. Imagine that all of your classmates leave the classroom and go home, but you have to sit alone in the classroom for an hour while waiting for your mother or father to pick you up from school.
How would you feel?
9. How would you feel if you were alone in the dark for a long time?
10. How does a person who is smiling and laughing feel?
11. How does a person who is crying feel?
12. How does a person with a frown on their face feel?

X. The Weather

1. What is the weather like in summer?
2. What is the weather like in spring?
3. What is the weather like in autumn?
4. What is the weather like in winter?
5. What kind of weather means that you cannot go to the park?
6. When is it difficult to see our surroundings and things in the distance clearly because of the weather?
7. If the trees are shaking their leaves or the leaves are flying through the air, what is the weather like?
→ If it is very, really windy, what do we call the weather?
8. If sounds and flashes of light are coming from the sky, what do we say is happening?

9. When you hear “The weather is clear,” what kind of weather do you imagine?
10. When you hear “The weather is overcast,” what kind of weather do you imagine?

XI. Identity/Self

1. Can you introduce yourself?
2. Can you describe your physical appearance?
3. What are some good characteristics that you have?
(For example, being honest is a good character trait.)
4. What are some bad characteristics that you have?
(For example, being dishonest is a bad character trait.)
5. What do you think you are good at? What kinds of things or subjects are you good at, successful in, or talented in?
6. What do you think you are not good at? What kinds of things or subjects are you not good at, not successful in, or not talented in?
7. Do you think you are someone whom people around you like? → How can you tell that people like you from the way they treat you or what they say to you? → How can you tell that people do not like you from the way they treat you or what they say to you?

XII. Books

1. Do you like reading books? → If yes, what kinds of books do you like reading? → If no, why not?
2. When do you usually read books?
3. How do you feel when you are reading a book?

4. Can you tell me the name of one of your favorite books? → What happens in that book? → Why do you like that book so much?
5. What do you pay attention to when buying or choosing a book?
6. Is reading books necessary or useful? If yes or no, why?

XIII. Personal care

1. Let's think about our whole body from head to toe. Which parts of our body do we need to clean, and how should we clean them?
2. What products do we need when we do things to clean ourselves?
(For example, what do we use when washing our hands?)
3. When do we need to wash our hands? What should we do before or after?
4. What do we need to do and what products do we need to keep our hair clean and well-groomed?
5. Does it matter whether our fingernails are clean or dirty? If yes or no, why?
6. What do we need to do to keep our mouth and teeth clean?
7. Does it matter whether the clothes we wear are clean or dirty? If yes or no, why?
8. What happens if we are not clean?

XIV. Clothes

1. What comes to mind when you hear "clothes"? Please name all the types of clothing you know.
2. What kind of clothes do you like wearing?
3. What color clothes do you like wearing?
4. What color clothes do you not like wearing?
5. Do the clothes we wear change depending on the weather? If yes, what do we wear in different kinds of weather?

6. What do you choose your clothes based on?

XV. Culture and Art

1. Which countries other than Türkiye do you know? → Are the cultures of these countries different from one another?
2. If the cultures of two countries are different, in what ways are they different? → Are the languages, foods, and clothing of the people living there different?
3. What does “art” mean?
4. Which branches of art do you know?

XVI. Curiosity

1. What are you curious about? What would you like to learn or understand better?
(Prompting questions: For example, what are you curious about regarding the sky, space, vehicles, or machines? Are you curious about things such as how people travel to space, how astronauts live, how cars work, or how computers work?)
2. What would you like to watch or observe?
(Prompting questions: Would you like to watch from a distance what an elephant does during a day? Would you like to go into space and observe the Earth from far away?)

XVII. Occupations

1. What does “occupation” or “profession” mean?
2. Can you name all the occupations you know and tell me what people in those occupations do?
(Prompting questions: What could the occupation be of someone who works in a hospital / works

at a school / does work related to nature / sells things / works with machines / drives a means of transportation / works in security / works in sports / works with animals / has very good manual skills / works in justice or law?)

3. What do you want to be or what profession would you like to have when you grow up? Why?
4. Which occupations do you think are important? Why?
5. Which occupations do you think are difficult? Why?
6. Which occupations do you think are easy? Why?
7. Does everyone have an occupation? If yes or no, why?
8. What do people consider when choosing an occupation?

XVIII. Rooms and Furnitures

1. What rooms are there in a house?
2. What do people do in that room?
3. What things or furniture are there in that room?
4. What shapes can different pieces of furniture have? (*Prompting questions: What shape is a wardrobe? What shape can a table be?*)
5. Imagine a house. It will be your house. You can have anything you want in this house. What rooms and things would you like to have in this house? Can you describe them in terms of their colors and shapes? What color and shape would you like each room to be? What things would you like to have inside the room, and what colors and shapes would they be?

XIX. School Life and Classes

1. What are the first things that come to mind when you hear “school”?
2. Who are the first people that come to mind when you hear “school”?

3. What places are there at school? (*Prompting question: Where do you have classes? Where do you eat? Where do you play? Where do teachers sit during recess?*)
4. What classes do you have at school?
5. What do you do and what do you learn or have you learned in these classes? → What do you do and what do you learn or have you learned in Turkish class? → What do you do and what do you learn or have you learned in mathematics class?
6. Have you learned how to write in Turkish class? → Suppose we wrote a sentence. What do we put at the end of the sentence to show that it is finished? → What other punctuation marks do you know that we use when writing, such as a period? → Why do we use these marks? Why are they necessary?
7. Have you learned numbers in mathematics class → What comes to mind when you hear “types of numbers”? (*For example, odd numbers, even numbers, two-digit numbers, three-digit numbers.*) → Are there different ways of counting numbers? (*For example, counting by ones, counting by tens, counting backwards.*) → Why do we use numbers? Why are numbers necessary?
8. What is your favorite class or classes? Why?
9. Which classes do you not like or find difficult? Why?
10. Are there rules at school? If so, what are they?
11. What is a normal day at school like for you? Can you tell me about the time you spend at school, from the moment you first enter the school until you leave?

XX. Money and Financial Concepts

1. Why is it necessary to buy a toy, clothes, or food?
2. What does “money” mean?
3. What can we do with money?

4. When we buy something, what can we use to pay besides money?
5. Which occupations and workplaces related to money do you know?
6. What should we spend money on and what should we not spend money on?

XXI. Travelling and Means of Transportation

1. What does it mean to travel?
2. What do we do and what preparations do we make before going on a trip?
3. What do we need to ride/take in order to travel?
4. When do you usually travel, and who do you usually travel with?
5. What do people do while traveling?
6. What do people do after returning from a trip?

XXII. Rights, Responsibilities and Social Concepts

1. What does “responsibility” mean?
2. Do you have responsibilities? If so, what are they? *(For example, do you have responsibilities at home? Are there things you are expected to do or things that are your duties?)*
3. Does your mother have responsibilities? If so, what are they?
4. Does your father have responsibilities? If so, what are they?
5. What does “right” mean?
6. What are you allowed to do at home?
7. What are you not allowed to do at home?
8. What is a teacher allowed to do in a classroom, and what are they not allowed to do?
9. What are students allowed to do in a classroom, and what are they not allowed to do?
10. What does “justice” mean?

11. What does “equality” mean?

XXIII. Sports and Entertainment

1. Do you play any sports → Which sport do you play? → Why did you choose that sport?
2. Which sports do you know?
3. Is playing sports beneficial? If yes, why?
4. What kinds of things are fun for you? What do you enjoy doing?
5. What places are fun? (*Prompting question: Are amusement parks fun?*)

XXIV: Calendar: Days, Months and Time

1. What day of the week is it today? → How many days are there in a week, and what are they?
2. What month are we in? → How many months are there in a year, and what are they?
3. What seasons do we have in Türkiye?
4. What year are we in?
5. What do we call the different parts of the day?
6. What words do we use when talking about a time in the past?
(*Prompting question: What do we call the day before today?*)
7. Imagine that we are planning to meet someone somewhere. How do we tell that person when we will meet? What words do we use?
8. What words do we use when talking about a time in the future? (*Prompting question: What do we call the day after today?*)

XXV. Technology

1. Which technological devices do you know?
2. What are these devices used for?
3. If the student says “computer”: What can we do with computers? → How do computers work? → Can you describe what a computer looks like? → Do you know the names of the parts or accessories of a computer? If yes, can you name them? → Do computers have a brain?
4. Is using technological devices beneficial or harmful? Why?
5. What would our lives be like if there were no technological devices at all?

XXVI. Parts of the Body, Health and Medicine

1. What are the parts of our body?
2. What does each part of our body do? What are their functions?
3. What are the parts of our face?
4. What does each part of our face do? What are their functions?
5. What does “internal organs” mean? Which internal organs do you know?
6. What does each internal organ do? What are their functions?
7. What does it mean to be healthy?
8. What should we do to be healthy?
9. What does “medicine” mean?
10. What comes to mind when you hear “medicine”?
11. Why do we go to the hospital? → Which names of illnesses or diseases do you know?

XXVII. Foods and Beverages

1. Can you name all the drinks that come to mind?

2. Can you name all the foods that come to mind?
3. Which drinks are healthy?
4. Which drinks are unhealthy?
5. Which foods are healthy?
6. Which foods are unhealthy?
7. What does “dairy products” mean? → Can you give me an example?
8. What does “legumes” mean? → Can you give me an example?
9. What does “pastry/baked goods” mean? → Can you give me an example?
10. What kinds of desserts come to mind when you hear “types of desserts”? (*For example, syrup-based desserts.*)
11. Can you give me an example of a syrup-based dessert?
12. Can you give me an example of a milk-based dessert?
13. Do you know any foods or drinks from other countries? (*For example, sushi.*)

XXVIII. Directions

1. What is there in your neighborhood, around your house?
→ Can you describe where they are?
2. Imagine that we are standing at the entrance of your school. Can you describe where your classroom is?
3. Where are the Aegean Sea, the Black Sea, and the Mediterranean Sea in relation to Türkiye?
4. If we got lost in a forest, how could we find our way?

XIX. Forks, Knives, Plates, and Cooking Equipment

1. Imagine that we have put food and drinks on the table. What do we need to put on the table to eat and drink them?
2. What do you have in your kitchen cabinets?
3. Imagine that we have put the ingredients we need for cooking, such as vegetables and oil, on the kitchen counter. What do we need to cook them?
4. What do we need to put food from a pot or pan onto a plate?
5. Imagine that some guests have come over. Some of them want to drink tea and some want to drink coffee. We have tea and coffee. What do we need to make tea and coffee? → What do we need to take the tea and coffee to the living room?

XXX. Urban Facilities: Museums, Bus Stops, Parks, Hospitals, Health Centers, Libraries

1. Have you ever been to a museum? → What was there? → What did you do there? → What did you like? → What did you not like? → Are there rules in museums? If yes, what are they? → Why do museums exist?
2. Where should we wait when we want to get on a means of transportation? → What is a bus stop or other transportation stop like? How do people behave there? → Are there rules at transportation stops? How should people behave there, and how should they not behave?
3. What is there in parks? → What do people do in parks? → Do only children go to parks? → Why do adults go to parks?
4. What are hospitals like? Can you describe one? → Who is there? → Are there rules there? If yes, what are they?
5. Have you ever been to a health center? → What is it like? Can you describe it? → Who is there? → Are there rules there? If yes, what are they?

6. Have you ever been to a library? → What is it like? Can you describe it? → Who is there? → Are there rules there? If yes, what are they?